

Firearms Trace Data: Tennessee - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Tennessee in Calendar Year 2023

15,891

Firearm Types with a Tennessee Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	12,271
Rifles	1,425
Revolvers	1,136
Shotguns	671
Machineguns	95
Derringers	86
Machinegun Conversion Devices	77
Receivers/Frames	60
Other*	70

* Other includes Unknown Types, Silencers, a Combination and a Tear Gas Launcher.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Tennessee Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	7,402
.40 Cal	1,641
.22 Cal	1,012

.380 Cal	1,010
.45 Cal	798
.38 Cal	543
12GA	485
5.56mm	387
7.62mm	312
.223 Cal	277

NOTE: There were 1,593 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 431 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Tennessee Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	5,163
Possession of Weapon	1,828
Dangerous Drugs	1,649
Weapon Offense	1,641
Found Firearm	1,436
Simple Assault	1,027
Property Crimes	822
Aggravated Assault	454
Homicide	453
Robbery	222
Traffic Offense	222

NOTE: There were 974 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Tennessee Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Tennessee	9,373
Mississippi	959
Georgia	469
Alabama	288
Kentucky	279
Arkansas	243
Texas	225
Florida	207
North Carolina	108
Virginia	108
Indiana	91
Ohio	84
Missouri	75
Louisiana	70
South Carolina	70

NOTE: An additional 33 states and Puerto Rico accounted for 612 other traces. The source state was identified in 13,261 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Tennessee Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	834
3 Months to Under 7 Months	902
7 Months to Under 1 Year	864
1 Year to Under 2 Years	2,039
2 Years to Under 3 Years	1,942
3 Years and Over	6,572

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Tennessee Average Time-to-Crime: **6.18 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Tennessee Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	754
18 to 21	1,443
22 to 24	1,088
25 to 30	1,784
31 to 40	2,257
41 to 50	1,307
Over 50	1,077

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Tennessee Average Age of Possessor: **33 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Tennessee Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Memphis	5,760
Nashville	2,363
Knoxville	1,490
Chattanooga	1,229
Jackson	341
Clarksville	321
Gallatin	229
Antioch	199
Johnson City	165
Columbia	162

NOTE: There were 256 additional municipalities that accounted for 3,550 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for 82 traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Tennessee. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Tennessee.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.

- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a Tennessee Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Tennessee Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a Tennessee Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Tennessee Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Tennessee Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Tennessee Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024